

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Get ready to make an elevator pitch!



Learning Outcome

Discuss factual and abstract information about common everyday or job related topics in both work and social contexts appropriate for the interlocutor.

Can Do Statements

- I can exchange opinions about events or actions related to work and jobs.
- I can talk about solving problems.
- I can do an elevator pitch.

Ask your partner:

- Who are some important people you would like to be able to speak to? Why?
- If you had only 3 minutes to talk to these people, what would you say?





Let's Explore!

Adam practices his elevator pitch. He says he has a **knack*** for storytelling.

* To have a "knack" for something means you do something well. We do not pronounce the k.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Adam: Kristi, can you help me for a sec?

Kristi: Sure, what's up?

Adam: My elevator pitch needs polishing. That's what they call the little speech you say to someone as soon as you have the right opportunity, like during an interview or at the coffee break at a conference. I have been practicing ever since I met the headhunter. Do you want to hear it?

Kristi: Absolutely!

Adam: OK, here goes: I'm a communications professional with a knack for persuasive storytelling. While being new to professional writing, I have been published in 5 medium-circulation publications over the last year. Before doing that, I also worked for an independent paper and an award-winning magazine known as *The News Gazette*. I want to help express ideas through compelling and relatable stories while using the power of social media.

Kristi: Wow! That sounds amazing!

Adam: Thanks! Do you have any suggestions for improvement? Do you think it needs to be shortened?

Kristi: No, it doesn't need shortening, but I think you could say something about your abilities.

Adam: OK, something like: My core skill sets includes finding original angles and adding a touching human element to all stories.

Kristi: You are repeating yourself there, I think. How about something like more practical, like: My core skill set includes using a variety of editing software programs.

Adam: Good suggestion.

Kristi: I also think your ultimate goal needs emphasizing.

Adam: Yes, I agree that needs to be emphasized. How about: Because I'm inspired by international people and cultures, I'm looking for a position that uses my people skills as well as my writing skills to engage others in cultural and meaningful exchanges.

Kristi: You're hired!





Let's Practice!

Kristi listens to Adam talk about his elevator speech.

Instructions: Complete the sentences below by choosing from the options that you are given.

Word Bank

needs to be emphasized / needs to be shortened / needs polishing /
consider practicing / needs emphasizing

1. My elevator pitch_____.
2. Do you think it_____?
3. I also think your ultimate goal _____.
4. Yes, I agree, the goal _____.
5. You should _____ your speech more.



Let's Practice!

Adam talks about his core skill set.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Circle the incorrect word. Write the correct one on the line below the sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. My core skill set includes using a variety of editing software programs.

2. I also think your ultimate goaling needs emphasizing.

3. I'm looking for a disposition that uses my people skills.

4. I also have great writing skills that focus on engaged others in cultural and meaningful exchanges.

5. I'm a communications professionally with a knack for persuasive storytelling.



Extension Activity

Prepare your own elevator pitch.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose a job you would like to have or a project you would like to start.
- Go online. Find some sample elevator pitches for that job or project.
- Prepare an elevator pitch you could use at an interview or when you meet someone. Write an elevator pitch of 100 - 150 words. Make sure you use powerful language.
- Proofread the pitch. Make sure you use correct spelling and punctuation.
- Read your elevator pitch to a partner and ask for feedback.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I identify and read sample elevator pitches.

☐ ☐

I write an elevator pitch.

☐ ☐

I present my elevator pitch and ask for feedback.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to polish** (verb): to improve something
e.g. My elevator pitch needs polishing.
- **storytelling** (noun): the art of telling or writing stories
e.g. I'm a communications professional with a knack for persuasive storytelling.
- **improvement** (noun): a change that makes something better in some way
e.g. Thanks! Do you have any suggestions for improvement?
- **core** (adjective): main; major
e.g. My core skill sets includes finding original angles and adding a touching human element to all stories.
- **ultimate** (adjective): final
e.g. I also think your ultimate goal needs emphasizing.



Learning Points

Time Clauses: **as soon as**, **ever since** and **while**

You use time clauses in complex sentences. These kinds of sentences have a dependent clause and an independent clause, which are paired with a connector that indicates a specific point or period of time.

Common time markers that act as connectors are: **as soon as**, **ever since** and **while**.

As soon as refers to something that happens immediately.

For example:

*An elevator pitch is what they call the little speech you say to someone **as soon as** you have the right opportunity.*

In the above example, "an elevator pitch is what they call the little speech you say" is the independent clause, and the dependent clause is "you have the right opportunity". **As soon as** is the time clause connector.

Ever since refers to something that started at a particular point.

For example:

*I have been practicing my elevator pitch **ever since** I met the headhunter.*

While refers to a period of time.

For example:

*I want to help express ideas through compelling and relatable stories **while** using the power of social media.*





Learning Points

Linking Final Consonants to Beginning Vowels

When a word ends in a **consonant sound**, we often move the **consonant sound** to the beginning of the next word if it starts with a **vowel sound**.

Look at the following example:

turn off

The first word ends with the **consonant sound** "n". The second word begins with the **vowel sound** "o". In conversation, these two sounds are linked.

turn_off

The two words now sound like one word. This is one of the reasons why native English speakers are difficult to understand.

Practice saying these phrases and sentences. Focus on linking the consonant to the vowel.

Two words	Linked words	Example
needs emphasizing	needs_emphasizing	<i>I also think your ultimate goal needs emphasizing.</i>
engage other	engage_others	<i>I am looking for a position where I can engage clients with both my people and writing skills.</i>

